

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in property disputes, case file management, document preparation and client communication at BCLP, Citizens Advice East Berkshire and Q-Legal. At BCLP's Real Estate Disputes team, supported hearing preparation, maintained matter records on iManage and conducted legal research on leasehold, easement and landlord and tenant issues across a concurrent caseload. Currently advising clients on housing, debt and welfare matters at Citizens Advice, including drafting correspondence, managing case files and meeting deadlines. Focused, organised and comfortable handling confidential documents and client-facing work to a high standard.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural law and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module — 75%
- Dissertation on data protection and GDPR development across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial scholarship toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation across several concurrent property matters: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Maintained matter records on iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking
- Prepared client notes and managed large volumes of confidential documents across competing deadlines
- Assisted with cost comparisons and administrative matter management throughout the litigation lifecycle

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the memorial; conducted legal research
- Became the only junior supporting the team ahead of a significant deadline — coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated external Romanian translations

- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Advises clients on housing, welfare benefits, employment, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements and identifies key legal and evidential issues
- Manages matters from initial instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points
- Translates complex legal and procedural requirements into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable clients

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused written advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the submission deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer obligations
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; document review and electronic bundling; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems; concise report and correspondence writing

Case and evidence management: Matter file organisation, deadline tracking, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, confidential document handling across concurrent caseloads